

LING 102 section week 9 (3/29)

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1 The lexicon

Beyond X-bar Theory, we need additional *lexical information* that determines the number and types of arguments a verb combines with. We can represent this through the the following *lexical entries*:

- (1) *see*
 phonological form: /siy/
 semantic meaning: “to perceive with eyes”
 syntactic information: category: V
 PAS: {1,2}
 S-selection: {agent,theme}
 C-selection: {DP,DP}
- (2) a. **predicate argument structure (PAS)**: the number of arguments a verb takes
 b. **S(ematic)-selection**: the *thematic role* of each argument, e.g. agent, theme, goal, proposition, location, experiencer, recipient, question, etc.
 c. **C(ategory)-selection**: the category of each argument, e.g. DP, CP, PP, etc.
 d. **theta criterion**: each argument is assigned one and only one theta role, and vice versa

Draw the *theta grids* for the following verbs:

- (3) a. *put*
 PAS:
 S-selection:
 C-selection:
- b. *declare*
 PAS:
 S-selection:
 C-selection:

2 Movement

There are two main forces to balance when understanding linguistic variation. On the one hand, we know that languages have a lot in common. On the other hand, there are also a lot of differences we can observe. This can be thought of as the tension between *D-structure* and *S-structure*.

- (4) a. **D(eep)-structure**: the underlying representation of syntactic structure
 b. **S(urface)-structure**: the surface manifestation of syntactic structure

We have seen some mechanisms which transform D-structure into S-structure in languages, giving us differences in word order, differences in the number of morphemes represented in a word, etc.

- (5) a. **head movement**: movement of a lower head into a higher head
 b. **phrasal movement**: movement of a phrase from a lower specifier to a higher specifier
 c. **affix hopping**: lowering of an *affix* from a higher head to a lower head

2.1 English auxiliaries

Apply the mechanisms in (5) and draw trees for the following sentences. Recall the following:

- (6)
 - a. be_{PASS} : passive, the following auxiliary or verb takes the *-ed* suffix
 - b. be_{PROG} : progressive, the following auxiliary or verb takes the *-ing* suffix
 - c. do_{AUX} : *do*-support e.g. in negation, the following auxiliary or verb is bare
 - d. $have_{\text{PERF}}$: perfect, the following auxiliary or verb takes the *-en* suffix
- (7)
 - a. *Yvette often hugs Luna.*

b. *Yvette is often hugging Luna.*

c. *Yvette has often been hugging Luna.*

d. what type of movement mechanism(s) does English have?

2.2 French auxiliaries and negation

Observe the following differences between English and French.

- (8) a. **Lily pets often Julius.*
b. *Lily often pets Julius.*
- (9) a. *I have often eaten apples.*
b. ?*I often have eaten apples.*
- (10) a. *Lily carasse souvent Julius*
Lily pets often Julius
b. **Lily souvent carasse Julius*
Lily often pets Julius
- (11) a. *J' ai souvent mangé des pommes*
I have often eaten the apples
b. **Je souvent ai mangé des pommes*
I often have eaten the apples
- (12) a. draw the tree for the sentence *Lily caraase souvent Julius* in (10a).

b. what type of movement mechanism(s) does French have?

- (13) a. *I do not eat apples.*
b. *I have not eaten apples.*
c. *I can not eat apples.*
- (14) a. *Je ne-mange pas des pommes*
I NEG-eat not the apples
b. *Je n'-ai pas mangé des pommes*
I NEG-have not eaten the apples
- (15) a. what can we understand about the behavior of the negative particles *not* and *pas*?

2.3 Irish word order

- (16) a. *phóg an fear an mhuc*
 kiss the man the pig
 b. *phóg an fear an mhuc go minic*
 kiss the man the pig often
- (17) a. draw the tree for the sentence *phóg an fear an mhuc* in (16a).

- b. what type of movement mechanism(s) does Irish have?

2.4 summary

To summarize the movement mechanisms in each language:

	English*	French	Irish
T is [+strong]: V-to-T movement	–	+	+
T is [+EPP]: DP movement from Spec,VP to Spec,TP	+	+	–

*English also has affix hopping from T to V (including Aux)

These differences in movement derive differences in word order in these languages, even though their most basic underlying structure is the same. We can think of these differences in terms of features:

- (18) a. head movement is determined by the **[±strong] feature** on the higher head
 b. phrasal movement is determined by the **[±EPP] feature** on the higher head

We will learn more about these in future classes. Also, some universals on underlying structure:

- (19) a. **VP-internal subject hypothesis (VPISH)**: all arguments of verbs originate within the VP, whether in the specifier (agent) or complement (theme) position of the verb
 b. **temporal adverbs** and **negative particles** are adjuncts that attach to the highest X' level of out of all the verbs or auxiliaries present, i.e. the highest V' or Aux'